

What a friend we have in Jesus

Text: Joseph M. Scriven, 1855, alt.

Music: Charles C. Converse, 1868

CONVERSE 87.87 D

The musical score is written for a single voice part in 4/4 time, with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The melody is simple and hymn-like, with a range of approximately two octaves. The lyrics are arranged in four systems, each with two columns of text. The first system includes three numbered verses. The second system has three lines of text. The third system has two lines of text. The fourth system has three lines of text. Chord symbols (F, Bb, C, C7) are placed above the staff at various points, indicating the harmonic structure. The score ends with a double bar line.

1 What a friend we have in Je - sus, all our sins and griefs to bear!
2 Have we tri - als and temp - ta - tions? Is there trou - ble an - y - where?
3 Are we weak and heav - y la - den, 'cum - bered with a load of care?

What a priv - i - lege to car - ry ev - 'ry - thing to God in prayer!
We should nev - er be dis - cour - aged - take it to the Lord in prayer!
Pre - cious Sav - ior, still our ref - uge, take it to the Lord in prayer!

Oh, what peace we of - ten for - feit, oh, what need - less pain we bear,
Can we find a friend so faith - ful, who will all our sor - rows share?
Do thy friends de - spise, for - sake thee? Take it to the Lord in prayer!

all be - cause we do not car - ry ev - 'ry - thing to God in prayer!
Je - sus knows our ev - 'ry weak - ness - take it to the Lord in prayer!
Je - sus' arms will take and shield thee - thou wilt find a sol - ace there.